

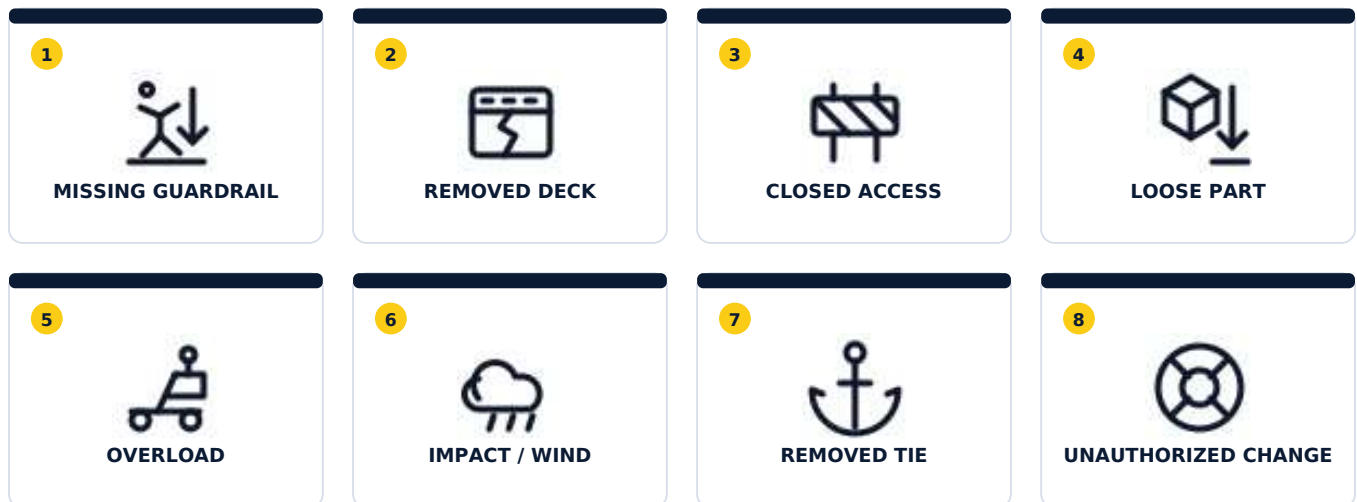
HSE TOOLBOX TALK

SCAFFOLD MODIFICATION CONTROL

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Unauthorized changes to guardrails, decks, braces, ties, ladders or brackets invalidate scaffold integrity and tagging. Only an authorized scaffold crew may modify the structure to the design and manufacturer requirements. Close the scaffold, reinspect it and do not reopen until a competent person updates the tag.

KEY HAZARDS



CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

Each shift

Competent-person visible-defect inspection

4 x

Capacity against maximum intended load

0

Tolerance for unauthorized changes



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA Subpart L places changes affecting scaffold integrity under competent and qualified-person control. A tag does not replace physical inspection; it records the inspection result.

OSHA 1926.451(a)(6)

QUALIFIED DESIGN

A qualified person must design the scaffold, which must be erected and loaded in accordance with that design.

OSHA 1926.451(f)(3)

REINSPECTION

A competent person must inspect before each shift and after any event or change affecting integrity.

OSHA 1926.451(f)(7)

ERECTION AND ALTERATION

Erection, movement, dismantling and alteration must be supervised by a competent person and performed by trained employees.

OSHA 1926.454

TRAINING AND RETRAINING

Employees must understand scaffold hazards and correct use; retraining is required when deficiencies or changes are identified.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Approved scaffold drawing | ☐ Change request and work order |
| ☐ Authorized crew record | ☐ Red / green tag record |
| ☐ Reinspection form | ☐ User briefing |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Who is authorized to remove a component?
- How is access to a red-tagged scaffold prevented?
- Why is the whole scaffold inspected after a change?

CLOSURE AND INSPECTION OF AN ALTERED SCAFFOLD



Block access - Red tag - Authorized correction - Reapprove

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. REDUCE THE NEED FOR CHANGE

Plan work scope and access before erection; eliminate later removal through the design.

2. CLOSE THE SCAFFOLD

If a component is missing or changed, physically block access and apply a red tag.

3. CORRECT WITH AN AUTHORIZED CREW

Only an approved scaffold crew may alter the scaffold to the design and manufacturer instructions.

4. REINSPECT AND RELEASE

Do not resume use until a competent person checks the entire system and renews the tag.

CRITICAL WARNING



Removing a guardrail, brace, tie or deck unit 'for a moment' is not safe. Close the scaffold immediately; never make unauthorized repairs or use improvised components.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Tag and shift inspection valid | ☐ No sign of unauthorized alteration |
| ☐ Guardrails and decks complete | ☐ Braces and ties complete |
| ☐ Access system unchanged | ☐ Loading matches design |
| ☐ Defective area physically closed | ☐ Modification record available |
| ☐ Competent person reapproved | |

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SCAFFOLD MODIFICATION CONTROL

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			